Product Requirements Document

Franchise Development & Expansion Brokerage Platform

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Document status

Status: Research-backed draft for client and stakeholder validation
Initial market assumption: India, subject to confirmation
Document owner: Product / Business Development

Document purpose

This document defines the first product direction for a business that helps established local brands prepare for franchising and find qualified expansion partners. It turns the initial service description into a product that can be scoped, designed, built and evaluated.

The original brief is deliberately broad: package a proven brand's operating procedures, coordinate franchise-related legal documentation, and recruit multi-unit franchisee investors. This PRD treats those as three connected workstreams rather than three unrelated services.

The product should support the work of a specialist brokerage and its clients. It is not intended to replace franchise consultants, lawyers, accountants or the commercial judgement of the brand owner.

1. Executive summary

Many local businesses reach a point where customers want more outlets, but the business is not yet ready to be operated by people outside the founding team. Important processes may live in the owner's memory, unit-level economics may not be consistently documented, legal records may be scattered, and prospective investors may be assessed through informal conversations and spreadsheets. As a result, expansion discussions can begin before the brand has established what it is selling, what a franchisee must invest, or what support the franchisor can reliably provide.

The proposed platform gives a franchise development and expansion brokerage one workspace to manage that journey. It records the evidence behind a brand's readiness, coordinates the creation and approval of standard operating procedures (SOPs), tracks legal and commercial preparation with qualified professionals, builds a clear expansion proposition, and manages investor qualification through to a consent-based introduction and deal process.

The product is designed around a simple rule: **a brand should not be presented to investors as franchise-ready until the required evidence, operating material, commercial terms and legal review have passed the relevant human approval gates.** A checklist marked complete is not a legal opinion, and a matching score is not an investment recommendation.

The first release should be a brokerage operating workspace with secure brand and investor access. It should not begin as a large public franchise marketplace. Public listings, automated document drafting, payments, e-signature and full post-award franchise operations can be considered after the core service workflow has been proven.

Product outcome

A brokerage team can take a brand from initial assessment to an approved expansion proposition, identify investors who meet the brand's stated criteria, obtain permission from both sides before sharing contact details, and maintain a traceable record of each step.

Primary users

Brokerage team members who manage brand engagements, investor relationships and deals.

Brand owners and their nominated managers who provide information, approve operating material and confirm expansion terms.

Prospective franchise partners, particularly operators capable of developing more than one unit.

External legal, finance and operations advisers who receive limited access to the specific work they are reviewing.

2. Background and problem definition

The reference brief identifies three services: packaging SOPs, preparing legal FDDs and recruiting multi-unit franchisee investors. Each depends on information produced by the others.

A credible investor proposition requires more than a brochure. It depends on a repeatable operating model, a clear description of the support the brand will provide, credible unit-level economics, a defensible territory and expansion plan, and legal documents reviewed for the relevant jurisdiction. Investor recruitment also needs a process for assessing operating capability, financial capacity, geography, sector preference and willingness to develop multiple locations.

When these activities are handled in separate files, email threads and spreadsheets, several problems appear:

Founder knowledge is difficult to transfer. The business may run well because a small number of people know how to solve recurring problems. That knowledge is rarely captured in a form another operator can follow.

Readiness is hard to evidence. A brand may claim that it is ready to franchise without having reliable records of outlet performance, supply capacity, training, brand ownership or support resources.

Documents become inconsistent. SOPs, fee schedules, pitch materials, contracts and disclosure documents can be circulated in different versions. A recipient may rely on an outdated file.

Investor quality is uneven. A person with sufficient capital is not necessarily capable of running several outlets. Sector experience, time commitment, management capacity and geography matter.

Introductions are difficult to audit. Teams may lose the history of who was introduced to whom, what information was shared, whether consent was obtained and what action is due next.

The brokerage lacks a reliable portfolio view. Management cannot easily see which brands are blocked, what evidence is missing, where legal review is pending, or which investor relationships are progressing.

The platform addresses these operational gaps. It does not guarantee that a brand will succeed, that a franchisee will be profitable, or that an investor will complete a transaction.

3. Market research and competitive landscape

The research reviewed publicly described products and services available as of 10 November 2026. The findings below are based on vendor websites and product pages; they describe what vendors publicly advertise, not independently verified product performance.

3.1 Competitors and adjacent products

Franchise India / FranGlobal [R1][R2]. Franchise consulting, brand expansion, market-entry support and connections between brands and prospective franchise partners. FranGlobal also describes cross-border expansion and strategic partnerships. *Product implication:* The proposition cannot rely on introductions or consulting access alone. The brokerage needs a consistent way to qualify brands, capture deliverables and manage execution.

Sparkleminds [R3]. Franchise model development, commercial and operational frameworks, expansion strategy and the role of SOPs in maintaining consistency. *Product implication:* SOP development and franchise model design are established consulting services. The platform should make the work repeatable and trackable, rather than claim to invent the service category.

LoQal FranX [R4]. An India-focused franchise growth platform advertising AI-assisted enquiry qualification, brand-investor matching, follow-up across communication channels, CRM pipeline tracking and document extraction.

Product implication: Basic investor matching, lead scoring and follow-up automation are not sufficient points of difference. The product should make readiness evidence and approval status central to the matching process.

FicoFoco [R5]. An Indian franchise and retail expansion marketplace covering brands, investors and property owners. It describes consent-based introductions, match explanations, a private deal room, diligence packs and a brand workspace. *Product implication:* Privacy-controlled discovery and a deal room are already visible market expectations. The proposed product should focus on the brokerage's managed service workflow and the quality of the evidence behind an opportunity.

FranConnect [R6]. Franchise development CRM, candidate pipeline, follow-up automation, FDD and contract document management, opening workflows and broader franchise operations modules. *Product implication:* A broad franchise lifecycle platform is an established category. The first release should not attempt to reproduce enterprise operations, royalty or field-service modules.

ClientTether [R7]. Franchise CRM with lead capture, lead routing, pipeline visibility, sales automation, contact segmentation and communication tools. *Product implication:* The brokerage needs disciplined relationship management, but a generic CRM with franchise labels would not solve the brand-readiness and documentation problem.

Way We Do [R8]. Active SOP and operations-manual software with procedure authoring, workflow/checklist execution, training and policy acknowledgement. *Product implication:* SOPs should be structured and version-controlled, with a route to practical use. Merely uploading a PDF library is not enough.

IFPG [R9]. A professional network connecting franchisors, franchise consultants, brokers, lenders and other franchise professionals. *Product implication:* Human networks and specialist judgement remain important. The product should support advisers and referral partners rather than try to remove them from the process.

3.2 What the research means

The market already contains products for franchise consulting, marketplace discovery, investor CRM, candidate matching, SOP management and franchise lifecycle operations. The product should not be positioned as the first platform to offer any of those individual capabilities.

The opportunity is to connect them around a managed brokerage engagement:

A brand's readiness record is supported by evidence, not only self-reported claims.

SOPs, commercial terms and legal review are tracked as separate workstreams with named owners and current versions.

An opportunity is not released to investor sourcing until the brokerage and brand owner approve the required material.

Investor qualification distinguishes capital availability from the ability and intention to operate or develop multiple units.

A match includes the reasons it fits, the information still missing and the approval required before the parties are introduced.

Every introduction and document disclosure is recorded.

This is a positioning hypothesis to validate through customer interviews. It is not a claim that competitors cannot provide similar services or functionality.

3.3 Competitive position

Positioning: A workflow and client workspace for franchise development advisers who prepare local brands for expansion and manage qualified investor relationships.

Not the positioning: Another open directory of franchise opportunities, a replacement for a full franchise operations suite, a law firm, or an investment marketplace that holds client funds.

4. Product vision, principles and goals

4.1 Vision

Make franchise expansion more disciplined for local brands and more transparent for prospective operating partners.

4.2 Product principles

Evidence before claims. Important brand statements should have a source, owner and review status.

Human approval at material gates. Readiness, legal review, investor qualification and introductions require named people to approve them.

One current version. Users should be able to identify the latest approved SOP, commercial proposition or legal document.

Separate expertise, responsibilities and liability. The platform coordinates professional work; it does not replace legal, accounting or operational advice.

Consent before disclosure. Private brand and investor information should not be shared simply because a match exists.

Explain decisions. Users should be able to understand why a brand or investor was shortlisted and which criteria were used.

Start with the managed service. Build for the brokerage's real workflow before investing in public marketplace scale.

4.3 Goals

Give the brokerage a single record for each brand engagement and investor relationship.

Make brand readiness assessable across operating, commercial, management and legal workstreams.

Capture and maintain approved SOPs with ownership, version history and review dates.

Organize legal-readiness documents and counsel actions by jurisdiction.

Produce a consistent expansion profile with transparent financial assumptions.

Identify and qualify investors who meet a brand's operating and expansion criteria.

Manage consent-based introductions and deal progression.

Give brokerage leadership visibility into workload, bottlenecks and conversion through the pipeline.

4.4 Non-goals for the first release

A public, searchable marketplace of every brand and investor.

Legal advice, automated legal opinions or guaranteed compliant contracts.

Automatic generation or filing of a US Franchise Disclosure Document (FDD).

Valuation advice, securities distribution, pooled investment, custody of funds or investment recommendations.

A complete franchisee operations suite covering royalty collection, POS integration, field audits, inventory, payroll and supply-chain management.

Automated background checks, identity verification or credit decisions built in-house.

A promise that any readiness status predicts the commercial success of a franchise.

5. Market and jurisdiction assumptions

The initial product design assumes the brokerage is serving brands and prospective franchise partners in India. This assumption must be confirmed with the client before the legal checklist, templates, user consent text or data-retention rules are configured.

The term **FDD** needs careful handling. In the United States, the Federal Trade Commission's Franchise Rule requires a disclosure document containing 23 specified items; a prospective franchisee generally must receive it at least 14

calendar days before signing a binding agreement or making a payment to the franchisor or an affiliate [R10][R11]. This is a US-specific regulatory framework and should not be treated as a universal franchise document.

The Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister has discussed the absence of a single comprehensive franchise-specific law and centralized franchise regulator in India [R12]. That does not mean franchise transactions are unregulated. The relevant contract, intellectual-property, tax, consumer, competition, employment, data-protection and sector-specific requirements may still apply. The platform must therefore use a **jurisdiction-specific legal-readiness checklist**, and a qualified lawyer must determine what applies to each brand and transaction.

For an India deployment, the product should be designed with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 and the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 in view. The commencement notification provides for phased implementation, so the applicable provisions and dates should be checked with counsel at launch and when the rules change [R13][R14].

If the client intends to serve the United States, the UK, the UAE or other markets, the legal workflow must be separately configured for each jurisdiction. The product must not reuse India's checklist or label it an FDD checklist.

6. Users and permissions

Brokerage administrator. Manage clients, team access, templates, pipeline settings and portfolio reporting. *Access:* Full brokerage workspace access, subject to audit logging.

Franchise development adviser. Own brand engagements, assess readiness, coordinate workstreams and approve progression within delegated authority. *Access:* Assigned brands, investors, documents and deals.

SOP / operations specialist. Capture processes, draft SOPs, manage reviews and maintain operating manuals. *Access:* Assigned brand processes and related evidence; no access to unrelated investor financial documents.

Brand owner / brand manager. Supply evidence, review operating and commercial material, confirm facts and approve investor-facing content. *Access:* Own brand workspace; cannot see other brands or investor records unless explicitly shared.

External legal reviewer. Review the relevant legal documents and record comments, status and sign-off. *Access:* Time-limited access to explicitly assigned legal documents and actions only.

Investor / prospective franchisee. Maintain a profile, state investment and operating preferences, review approved opportunities and manage introductions. *Access:* Own profile and opportunities deliberately shared with them.

Platform administrator. Maintain security, system configuration and support access. *Access:* Technical access under least-privilege controls; privileged activity must be logged.

Access is granted by role and by engagement. A user who can access one brand must not automatically gain access to another brand. Internal staff access should be limited to assigned work unless the user has an administrative responsibility.

7. Core user journeys

7.1 Brand onboarding and readiness assessment

A brokerage adviser creates a brand engagement and records the business's name, legal entity, sector, operating locations, ownership contacts and proposed expansion markets.

The brand owner receives an invitation to complete an intake form and upload supporting records.

The adviser records the brand's history, outlet performance, management structure, supply model, training capability, intellectual-property position and expansion objectives.

Each claim is marked as self-reported, supported by evidence, reviewed, or unresolved.

The brokerage performs a readiness review across operating repeatability, unit economics, brand/IP, management capacity and legal preparation.

The system creates a remediation plan with an owner and due date for each gap.

The brand can progress only when the designated approvers confirm the relevant gates.

A readiness result is a workflow status with reasons. It must not be presented as a credit rating, legal certification or prediction of franchise performance.

7.2 SOP development and approval

The operations specialist creates a process inventory for the brand.

The brand identifies who performs each process, where it applies, how often it is performed and what standard is expected.

The specialist drafts or uploads the SOP and links any source material or evidence.

The brand owner or assigned process owner reviews the draft and records requested changes.

An authorized reviewer approves the final version, effective date and next review date.

The previous version remains available as superseded history; users are directed to the current approved version.

Where needed, the adviser records which training or acknowledgement must accompany publication.

7.3 Legal-readiness coordination

The adviser selects the transaction jurisdiction and business sector.

The system displays the checklist configured for that jurisdiction.

The brand uploads existing agreements, registrations, IP records, fee schedules, disclosure material and other requested documents.

The adviser records missing information and assigns actions to the brand or legal reviewer.

The legal reviewer records comments, requested changes and the scope of review.

The brand and brokerage can see whether the legal pack is not started, in preparation, with counsel, returned for changes or cleared by counsel for the stated purpose.

The platform records the review date, reviewer and document version. It does not declare a legal document compliant on its own.

7.4 Expansion proposition preparation

The adviser defines the franchise model under consideration: single-unit, multi-unit development, area development, master franchise or another model approved by counsel.

The brand supplies the investment range, franchise fee, expected setup costs, working-capital assumptions, royalty structure, marketing contributions and territory requirements.

The adviser records the source and date of each financial assumption and distinguishes actual historical data from estimates and projections.

The brand confirms the proposition and supporting materials.

An authorized reviewer marks the opportunity as approved for investor outreach.

Only approved and explicitly shareable fields are shown to investors.

7.5 Investor onboarding and qualification

The investor creates a profile or is entered by the brokerage with an appropriate lawful basis and privacy notice.

The investor specifies preferred sectors, cities or regions, investment range, development capacity, intended number of units, preferred role and target timing.

The adviser captures operating experience, team capacity, available capital evidence and any constraints relevant to the opportunity.

Verification is recorded as a human review status, not inferred from a completed form.

The investor can update preferences and withdraw interest.

The system must distinguish a person who wants to own and operate several outlets from a passive capital provider, an area developer or a master franchisee. Those are different commercial roles and may require different agreements.

7.6 Matching, introduction and deal progression

The system filters investors against the opportunity's approved criteria.

It shows a match explanation, including criteria met, criteria not met and missing information.

A brokerage adviser reviews the shortlist and decides whether the match is appropriate to propose.

The brand and investor each approve the proposed introduction.

The system records the consent, timestamp, parties, information to be shared and the version of the opportunity pack.

Contact details become visible only after both approvals are recorded.

The adviser tracks meetings, due diligence, questions, negotiations and agreed next actions.

The deal is closed, paused, declined or disqualified with a reason and final outcome.

A matching score may help organize a shortlist. It must never be the sole reason for an introduction or be described as a probability of investment success.

8. Product modules and functional requirements

Priority definitions: **P0** is required for the first usable release; **P1** is valuable after the main workflow is stable; **P2** is a later enhancement.

8.1 Brand workspace and evidence register

BR-01 - Create and maintain a brand engagement with entity, sector, location, operating history and owner contacts. (P0). *Acceptance:* An adviser can create, edit, assign and archive a brand record; required fields are validated.

BR-02 - Record outlets and operating history for each brand. (P0). *Acceptance:* A brand can have multiple locations with opening dates, format, status and available performance evidence.

BR-03 - Store supporting files and evidence references. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each file has a type, uploader, date, related claim, access level and review status.

BR-04 - Record whether a fact is self-reported, supported, reviewed or unresolved. (P0). *Acceptance:* Users can see the evidence status beside the relevant claim; unsupported information is not shown as verified.

BR-05 - Record readiness gaps, owners, due dates and closure notes. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each gap can be assigned, tracked, updated and closed with a recorded reviewer.

8.2 Readiness assessment

RA-01 - Assess operating repeatability, unit economics, brand/IP, management capacity and legal preparation. (P0). *Acceptance:* The assessment shows a status and evidence for each dimension.

RA-02 - Support configurable approval gates. (P0). *Acceptance:* A brand cannot move to investor outreach until required gates are approved by named users.

RA-03 - Show why a brand is blocked from progressing. (P0). *Acceptance:* The workspace lists unresolved gaps, responsible owners and due dates.

RA-04 - Preserve previous assessments. (P1). *Acceptance:* Users can view the date, assessor, changes and status of earlier reviews.

The first version should use clear statuses and evidence rather than a single opaque numerical readiness score.

8.3 SOP and operating manual management

SOP-01 - Maintain a process inventory by function and outlet type. (P0). *Acceptance:* A user can create, categorize, assign and search process records.

SOP-02 - Create or upload an SOP with owner, scope, status and version. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each SOP has a unique record, a draft/review/approved/superseded status and version history.

SOP-03 - Route an SOP for review and approval. (P0). *Acceptance:* Reviewers can approve or return a version with comments; approval is attributable to a user.

SOP-04 - Record effective date and next review date. (P0). *Acceptance:* The system highlights overdue or soon-to-be-reviewed SOPs.

SOP-05 - Maintain checklists and supporting training material linked to an SOP. (P1). *Acceptance:* A published SOP can link to a checklist or training asset without losing its version context.

SOP-06 - Export an approved operating manual or selected SOP pack. (P1). *Acceptance:* Export includes document title, version, status and effective date.

8.4 Legal-readiness workspace

LEG-01 - Select a jurisdiction and display its configured legal-readiness checklist. (P0). *Acceptance:* Checklist items are jurisdiction-tagged and do not mix legal regimes.

LEG-02 - Store legal documents and supporting records with version history. (P0). *Acceptance:* Users can identify the current file, previous files, reviewer and review date.

LEG-03 - Assign legal actions to the brand, brokerage or external counsel. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each action has an owner, due date, status and comment history.

LEG-04 - Restrict external counsel to assigned matters. (P0). *Acceptance:* Counsel cannot browse unrelated brand, investor or deal records.

LEG-05 - Record legal review outcome and scope. (P0). *Acceptance:* Status records who reviewed which version, for what purpose and when.

LEG-06 - Maintain jurisdiction-specific templates and clause libraries. (P2). *Acceptance:* Templates are versioned and approved by the relevant legal owner before use.

No legal document may be labelled “compliant” solely because all checklist items have been marked complete. The product should use labels such as “awaiting counsel”, “changes requested” and “counsel review recorded”.

8.5 Expansion proposition and unit economics

EXP-01 - Record the proposed franchise model and intended territory. (P0). *Acceptance:* Model type, geography, unit count and development period are stored per opportunity.

EXP-02 - Record investment components and recurring fees. (P0). *Acceptance:* Setup cost, franchise fee, working capital, royalty and other contributions have values, units and descriptions.

EXP-03 - Distinguish historical actuals, assumptions and projections. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each financial input has a type, source, date and owner.

EXP-04 - Create an investor-facing opportunity profile from approved fields. (P0). *Acceptance:* Only approved, shareable data is included in the profile.

EXP-05 - Present scenario ranges and explanatory assumptions. (P1). *Acceptance:* Users can inspect the assumptions behind any projected figures; no guaranteed-return language is used.

EXP-06 - Compare alternative franchise models or territory plans. (P2). *Acceptance:* Authorized users can compare saved versions without overwriting the approved proposition.

Financial calculations should be transparent and editable by authorized users. The product must not imply that projections are audited results or guaranteed returns.

8.6 Investor CRM and qualification

INV-01 - Create an investor profile with contact details and source. (P0). *Acceptance:* A profile can be created, assigned and updated with a recorded source.

INV-02 - Capture investment range, geography, sector and timing preferences. (P0). *Acceptance:* Search and filters use the structured fields rather than free-text notes alone.

INV-03 - Capture intended role and unit-development capability. (P0). *Acceptance:* The profile distinguishes single-unit operator, multi-unit operator, area developer, master franchisee and passive investor.

INV-04 - Record operating experience and management capacity. (P0). *Acceptance:* Advisers can record evidence and review status for relevant experience.

INV-05 - Record financial-capacity review status. (P0). *Acceptance:* Status is set by an authorized reviewer; the platform does not infer verification from uploaded documents.

INV-06 - Track contact history, tasks and follow-ups. (P0). *Acceptance:* Calls, emails, meetings, notes and next actions are visible to authorized brokerage users.

INV-07 - Allow investors to manage their profile and interest. (P1). *Acceptance:* Investors can update preferences and withdraw interest in an opportunity.

8.7 Matching and consent-based introductions

MAT-01 - Filter investors against approved opportunity criteria. (P0). *Acceptance:* Filters cover sector, geography, investment range, intended role and unit capacity.

MAT-02 - Explain the match. (P0). *Acceptance:* The system displays criteria met, criteria not met and missing information.

MAT-03 - Require adviser review before proposing an introduction. (P0). *Acceptance:* A match cannot directly reveal names or contact details.

MAT-04 - Capture approval from both sides before disclosure. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each party's approval is timestamped and linked to the proposed information disclosure.

MAT-05 - Record a reason when a proposed match is rejected. (P1). *Acceptance:* Advisers can record a structured reason for future review.

MAT-06 - Support configurable weighted ranking. (P1). *Acceptance:* Ranking weights are visible, adjustable by authorized users and never represented as an investment-success probability.

The MVP should use transparent rules-based filtering and ranking. Machine-learning recommendations are not required for the first release.

8.8 Deal room and pipeline

DEAL-01 - Track each opportunity through configurable stages. (P0). *Acceptance:* Users can move a deal through stages with timestamps, owners and next actions.

DEAL-02 - Create a private deal room after mutual consent. (P0). *Acceptance:* Only explicitly invited parties can access the room.

DEAL-03 - Share approved documents and track access. (P0). *Acceptance:* Each shared item has a version, access rule and activity record.

DEAL-04 - Record due-diligence questions and responses. (P1). *Acceptance:* Questions have an owner, status, due date and response history.

DEAL-05 - Close, pause or decline a deal with a reason. (P0). *Acceptance:* The final state and reason are recorded and reflected in reporting.

DEAL-06 - Export a deal activity history. (P1). *Acceptance:* An authorized user can export the transaction timeline and shared-document register.

8.9 Portfolio dashboard and administration

OPS-01 - Show all active brand engagements by stage and owner. (P0). *Acceptance:* Brokerage leadership can filter by status, adviser, sector and due date.

OPS-02 - Show outstanding readiness, SOP and legal actions. (P0). *Acceptance:* The dashboard identifies blocked items and overdue actions.

OPS-03 - Show investor pipeline and introduction outcomes. (P0). *Acceptance:* Users can see investor status, proposed matches, accepted introductions and deal outcomes.

OPS-04 - Configure roles and permissions. (P0). *Acceptance:* Admins can grant, change and revoke access; changes are logged.

OPS-05 - Maintain an audit trail for significant activities. (P0). *Acceptance:* Document uploads, approvals, sharing, consent, status changes and access changes are attributable and timestamped.

OPS-06 - Export operational reports. (P1). *Acceptance:* Authorized users can export selected pipeline and readiness data in a common format.

9. Business rules and workflow controls

The following rules apply across modules:

A brand cannot be marked **Approved for Investor Outreach** until the brokerage's required operating, commercial and legal-review gates are complete and the brand owner has approved the investor-facing profile.

The legal gate is jurisdiction-specific. A completed checklist is not equivalent to a lawyer's sign-off.

Every investor-facing financial figure must be labelled as historical, estimated or projected and must retain its source and date.

An investor match does not create an introduction. A brokerage adviser must review it, and both parties must consent to the disclosure.

A party's consent applies only to the stated opportunity and information package. A material change to the information being disclosed requires renewed approval where appropriate.

Contact details and confidential brand identity remain hidden until the configured disclosure condition is met.

Only approved SOP versions may be presented as current operating instructions.

Superseded documents remain in history but must not be presented as current.

A user can access only records and files permitted by role, engagement and deal-room invitation.

The platform must not receive or hold investor funds, franchise fees, deposits or transaction proceeds in the MVP.

A deal may be paused or declined without deleting its history.

A manual override must capture the user, date, reason and previous value.

10. Information model

The main records required for the first release are:

Brand. Legal entity, trading name, sector, contacts, ownership, locations, operating history, status and assigned adviser.

Brand location. Address/region, format, opening date, operational status and available performance records.

Brand evidence. Claim supported, file/reference, source, owner, date, confidentiality level and review status.

Readiness assessment. Assessment dimensions, findings, evidence links, reviewer, status, gaps and approval history.

Process / SOP. Process name, function, owner, scope, version, approval, effective date, review date and attachments.

Legal matter. Jurisdiction, matter type, counsel, checklist, documents, comments, status, review scope and sign-off record.

Expansion proposition. Franchise model, territories, units, fees, investment range, support commitments, approved content and version.

Financial assumption. Amount, currency, unit, classification (actual/assumption/projection), source, date and owner.

Investor. Contact information, preferences, intended role, investment range, experience, unit capacity, source and verification status.

Investor evidence. Evidence type, uploader/source, review status, reviewer, access restriction and retention rule.

Match. Brand opportunity, investor, criteria, fit explanation, score if used, adviser decision and status.

Introduction consent. Parties, opportunity, disclosure scope, consent status, timestamp and revocation history.

Deal. Parties, stage, owner, milestones, activity, questions, next action and outcome.

Shared document. Document version, recipient, permission, share date, expiry if applicable and access history.

Audit event. Actor, event type, record, timestamp, previous state, new state and reason where relevant.

A brand can have many locations, processes, SOPs, legal matters and opportunities. An investor can have many preferences, proposed matches and deals. A deal must be tied to one approved opportunity and the parties who consented to that transaction.

11. Experience and interface requirements

The product should feel like a professional advisory workspace, not a public directory. The interface should prioritize the current state of each engagement and the next action required.

Main navigation

Portfolio

Brands

SOP Library

Legal Readiness

Investors

Matches & Introductions

Deals

Reports

Settings

Key screens

Portfolio dashboard: active brands by stage, overdue actions, items waiting for counsel, SOPs awaiting approval, qualified investors, pending consents and deal-stage movement.

Brand workspace: overview, evidence, readiness, locations, SOPs, legal readiness, expansion proposition, investor activity and engagement history.

SOP workspace: process inventory, editor or file upload, reviewer comments, approval history, current version and review schedule.

Legal workspace: jurisdiction selector, checklist, document register, assigned legal actions, reviewer comments and status history.

Investor workspace: profile, investment preferences, intended role, operating experience, qualification evidence, relationship history and consent controls.

Match review: opportunity criteria alongside investor profile, matching explanation, missing information, conflict warnings and adviser decision.

Deal room: participants, approved opportunity pack, shared documents, questions, activity timeline, milestones and next actions.

Interaction requirements

Every list supports search, filtering and useful sorting.

Status labels use plain language and are accompanied by the action required to progress.

Forms save drafts and show validation errors close to the relevant field.

Uploads show progress, file type and size restrictions, and a clear result.

Users can identify the owner and next due date for each open task.

Confidential files are clearly marked before sharing or downloading.

Destructive actions require confirmation and are recorded.

The product should work on a standard desktop and remain usable on tablets and mobile screens for review and approvals.

12. Reporting and success measures

The product should measure the quality and movement of the brokerage process, not just the number of leads entered.

Primary product outcome

Qualified, mutually accepted investor introductions for brands that have passed the brokerage's readiness gates.

This metric connects the preparation work to the commercial outcome without claiming that an introduction guarantees a sale.

Operational measures

Time from brand intake to first readiness review.

Percentage of required brand evidence received and reviewed.

Number and age of unresolved readiness gaps.

Time taken to draft, review and approve SOPs.

Percentage of active SOPs with a named owner and current review date.

Number of legal matters awaiting brand information or counsel review.

Percentage of investor profiles with complete qualification information.

Time from investor enquiry to first human follow-up.

Match shortlist-to-introduction acceptance rate.

Introduction-to-meeting and meeting-to-due-diligence progression.

Deal stage duration and reasons for pause or decline.

Adviser time spent on administrative follow-up.

Guardrail measures

Number of disclosures made without recorded consent (target: zero).

Number of outdated or unapproved documents shared as current (target: zero).

Number of investor-facing opportunities released without required approval (target: zero).

Access-control incidents and data-sharing complaints.

Number of financial claims shown without source or classification.

Targets should be set after the brokerage records a baseline during the pilot. The product should not invent conversion benchmarks before the business has reliable historical data.

13. Security, privacy and governance

The platform will hold commercially sensitive information and personal data. Confidentiality and access control are core product requirements.

Minimum requirements

Role-based access and engagement-level permissions.

Separation of brand data, investor personal data and sensitive financial evidence.

Encryption in transit and at rest.

Secure file storage with short-lived access links where possible.

Audit logging for file upload, view, download, share, approval, consent and permission changes.

Clear privacy notice and documented purpose for collecting investor and contact information.

Data minimization: do not request identity, bank or financial documents unless a defined review purpose requires them.

Retention and deletion rules that can be configured by jurisdiction and contract.

A process for correcting inaccurate information and responding to access or deletion requests where applicable.

Backup, recovery and incident-response procedures.

No use of client documents to train general-purpose models without explicit, informed permission and a separate contractual basis.

Sensitive evidence

For the MVP, the platform should record a verification status and reviewer rather than attempt to verify identity, bank statements or source of funds itself. If formal KYC, AML or credit checks are required, use an appropriately authorized third-party provider after legal review. Do not build a custom identity-verification service into the first release.

Privacy-law configuration

For India, the client and implementation team should confirm applicable provisions and commencement dates under the DPDP Act and Rules with legal counsel. For other markets, a separate jurisdiction review is required. This PRD is not legal advice.

14. Non-functional requirements

Availability. The pilot should be available during the brokerage's working hours, with a documented recovery process. A production SLA is to be agreed with the client.

Performance. Common workspace pages should load promptly on ordinary business connections; large file uploads should be processed asynchronously. Baseline and target timings will be set during technical design.

Scalability. The data model must support multiple brands, many investors and multiple simultaneous deals without requiring a separate application for each brand.

Security. Apply least privilege, secure sessions, encryption, safe file handling and audit trails.

Reliability. Failed uploads and interrupted edits must not silently corrupt or overwrite existing approved records.

Usability. Common tasks should be discoverable without training from an engineer; forms should explain why requested information is needed.

Accessibility. Target WCAG 2.2 AA for core workflows, subject to validation during design and testing.

Maintainability. Workflow stages, jurisdiction checklists, document types and approval roles should be configurable rather than hard-coded for one client.

Interoperability. Support export of key records and documents. External CRM, e-signature, email and messaging integrations can follow after the MVP.

Auditability. Material changes and approvals must have a reliable history that ordinary users cannot edit or erase.

15. MVP scope and release approach

MVP: managed brokerage workflow

The first release should support one brokerage team and a small group of pilot brands and investors.

Included:

Brokerage staff login, roles and assigned work.

Brand intake, locations, evidence register and readiness assessment.

Readiness gaps, owners, due dates and approval gates.

SOP inventory, document upload, versioning, review and approval.

Jurisdiction-tagged legal-readiness checklist and counsel review status.

Expansion proposition with franchise model, territory, investment components and sourced assumptions.

Investor profile and structured qualification fields.

Transparent rules-based investor filtering and adviser-reviewed shortlist.

Mutual-consent introduction workflow.

Private deal workspace with approved document sharing and activity history.

Portfolio dashboard and basic operational reports.

Audit trail and secure access to files.

After the MVP

Public or semi-public brand discovery pages.

Investor self-service opportunity search and saved preferences.

Email and WhatsApp workflow automation.

CRM and calendar integrations.

E-signature integration with a suitable provider.

More advanced unit-economics scenario modelling.

Territory research and site-selection data.

AI-assisted extraction of information from uploaded documents, with source references and human confirmation.

Multi-country legal checklist packs maintained with local counsel.

Franchisee onboarding and post-award operational compliance.

Explicitly excluded from the first release

Automated legal drafting or legal approval.

A public investment marketplace or investment solicitation engine.

Handling, pooling or transferring deal funds.

Guaranteed financial performance statements.

An opaque AI investor ranking or automated rejection decision.

Full ERP, POS, accounting, inventory or royalty management.

16. Pilot acceptance criteria

The MVP is ready for a controlled pilot when all of the following are true:

An adviser can create a brand engagement and invite its owner to supply information.

A brand's key claims can be linked to supporting evidence and marked with a review status.

The adviser can create readiness gaps and prevent progression while required gates remain open.

An operations specialist can create an SOP, route it for review, approve a version and retain its history.

A legal reviewer can access only the assigned matter and record a review outcome against a specific document version.

An expansion proposition can be prepared from approved fields and distinguishes historical facts from assumptions and projections.

An investor can be profiled by budget, geography, sector, operating experience, intended role and unit-development capacity.

The brokerage can filter investors against an opportunity and understand why each investor appears in the shortlist.

The system does not disclose identity or contact information until both parties have approved the introduction.

A deal room can be created after consent, share approved files and maintain an activity history.

A user without permission cannot view another brand's confidential documents or an investor's restricted evidence.

Leadership can see active engagements, blockers, upcoming tasks, investor pipeline and deal outcomes.

Material changes, approvals, document sharing and permission updates appear in an audit trail.

The client can export the principal records and documents without losing their version and status information.

17. Key risks and mitigations

Brands are accepted before they are operationally ready.. The brokerage may damage its reputation and expose investors to weak propositions. *Mitigation:* Evidence-backed assessment, explicit approval gates and documented exceptions.

Financial projections are treated as promises.. Investors may rely on estimates as guaranteed returns. *Mitigation:* Label actuals, assumptions and projections; retain sources; require brand approval and professional review.

Incorrect or outdated legal documents are shared.. The product may contribute to a disclosure or contractual problem. *Mitigation:* Jurisdiction-specific workflow, version control, counsel review and access logs.

Investor information is over-shared.. Personal and financial data may be exposed without a business need. *Mitigation:* Least privilege, data minimization, consent gates and restricted evidence storage.

A capital-rich but unsuitable investor is treated as a good match.. Multi-unit expansion requires people and operating capability, not only capital. *Mitigation:* Capture intended role, management experience, unit capacity and time commitment.

The first release becomes a broad marketplace project.. Scope and delivery time become difficult to control. *Mitigation:* Build the brokerage workflow first; defer public discovery and large integrations.

The brokerage's process is not standardized.. Software will reproduce inconsistent work rather than improve it. *Mitigation:* Agree stage definitions, ownership and approval rules before configuration.

Vendor claims are mistaken for independent market proof.. Positioning may be based on marketing language rather than product evaluation. *Mitigation:* Validate competitor workflows through demos, trials and customer interviews before making strategic claims.

18. Open decisions for client discovery

The following decisions need to be confirmed before final design and implementation:

Initial jurisdiction: Is the first market India only, or must the product support another country at launch?

Legal scope: Who is responsible for legal document preparation and approval? Is external counsel already appointed?

Meaning of FDD: Does the client mean a US-style Franchise Disclosure Document, a general franchise information pack, or simply the set of legal and commercial documents required in its market?

Target brands: Which sectors and business sizes should be accepted first? What evidence makes a brand sufficiently established?

Brand readiness: Which conditions are mandatory before investor outreach, and who has authority to approve exceptions?

Franchise models: Will the brokerage support single-unit, multi-unit, area-development and master-franchise deals from day one?

Investor qualification: What investment range, evidence, operating experience and development capacity are required for each model?

Brokerage economics: Is revenue based on an advisory fee, retainer, success fee, or a combination? Who pays and at what milestone?

Confidentiality: Should brand identity be hidden until a mutual introduction is accepted? Which fields can be shown anonymously?

Existing tools: Does the brokerage already use a CRM, document repository, e-signature tool, email platform or WhatsApp Business provider?

Data handling: Where will data be hosted, how long will records be retained, and who is the data controller or equivalent responsible party for each workflow?

Pilot size: How many brokerage users, brands and investors will participate in the first pilot?

Success criteria: Which operational and commercial measures will determine whether the pilot should be expanded?

These are not reasons to delay the PRD. They are the specific decisions the product team should resolve with the client before implementation commitments are made.

19. Recommended product decisions

Based on the research and the initial service description, the recommended direction is:

Start with India as a configurable working assumption, not a permanent product limitation.

Build an internal brokerage workspace with secure brand and investor access; defer the public marketplace.

Treat brand readiness, SOP development, legal review and investor qualification as connected but separately approved workstreams.

Use evidence-backed statuses instead of a single opaque readiness score.

Use rules-based investor filtering in the MVP and show the reason for every suggested match.

Require human review and mutual consent before contact details or confidential brand information are shared.

Keep legal templates and review rules jurisdiction-specific and counsel-owned.

Keep projections transparent and never describe them as guaranteed outcomes.

Do not handle transaction funds in the first release.

Add AI assistance only when it reduces document handling or administration without replacing professional review.

The product should earn the right to become a marketplace or broader franchise management suite by first proving that it helps the brokerage prepare better brands and make better-qualified introductions.

20. Glossary

Franchisor. The brand owner granting rights to operate under its brand and system.

Franchisee. The party receiving those rights and operating the franchised business.

Multi-unit operator. A franchise partner intending and able to operate more than one outlet.

Area developer. A party granted development rights for an agreed territory or number of units, subject to the relevant contract.

Master franchisee. A party receiving broader rights that may include granting sub-franchises in a territory, subject to local law and contract.

SOP. Standard Operating Procedure: an approved instruction describing how a repeatable process is performed.

FDD. Franchise Disclosure Document; a defined disclosure document under the US FTC Franchise Rule. The term should not be applied automatically to other jurisdictions.

Readiness gate. A human-approved condition that must be met before a brand or opportunity can progress.

Deal room. A private workspace where approved parties share documents, questions and transaction updates.

21. Research sources

All competitor capability descriptions were taken from public product or service pages. Vendor statements are not independent assessments of performance. Sources were accessed on 10 November 2026 unless otherwise noted.

Competitor and market references

[R1] Franchise India - Expansion / consultation services. https://www.franchiseindia.com/expansion/

[R2] FranGlobal - About and franchise advisory services. https://franglobal.com/about-us/

[R3] Sparkleminds - Franchise model development. https://www.sparkleminds.com/franchising/franchise-model-development/

[R4] LoQal FranX - AI franchise CRM and brand-investor matchmaking. https://franx.loqal.ai/index.html

[R5] FicoFoco - Franchise and retail expansion marketplace, matching and deal room. https://ficofoco.com/

[R6] FranConnect - Franchise sales platform and lifecycle modules. https://www.franconnect.com/platform-overview/sales/ and https://help.franconnect.com/hc/en-us/articles/14481532468507-Welcome-to-FranConnect

[R7] ClientTether - Franchise CRM. https://clienttether.com/franchise-crm/

[R8] Way We Do - Franchise operations manuals and SOP software. https://www.waywedo.com/franchising/

[R9] International Franchise Professionals Group (IFPG) - About its professional network. https://www.ifpg.org/international-franchise-professionals-group.php

Legal and regulatory references

[R10] US Federal Trade Commission - Franchise Rule, 16 CFR Parts 436 and 437. https://search.ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/rules/franchise-rule

[R11] US Federal Trade Commission - A Consumer's Guide to Buying a Franchise. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/consumers-guide-buying-franchise

[R12] Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister - Need for Franchising Laws in India. https://eacpm.gov.in/reports/need-for-franchising-laws-in-india/

[R13] Gazette of India - DPDP Act commencement notification, G.S.R. 843(E), 13 November 2025. https://egazette.gov.in/WriteReadData/2025/267647.pdf

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